

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Soviet collapse mechanism

STAGNATION -> performance legitimacy falls

GLASNOST/PERESTROIKA -> criticism and reform expand

NATIONALISM/YELTSIN -> alternatives organise

NON-USE OF FORCE -> control becomes irreversible collapse

MUST REMEMBER: Gorbachev's reform phase, Eastern European revolutions of 1989, German unification in 1990 and dissolution of the USSR in 1991 are distinct stages in the Cold War's end.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Agency above and below

GORBACHEV -> reform and restraint from above

YELTSIN -> rival elite centre

SOLIDARITY -> organised strikes from below

RESULT -> structure, choice and mobilisation converge

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Collapse chronology

1985 -> Gorbachev takes power

AUG 1988 -> Solidarity strikes in Poland

1989 -> eastern European regimes collapse

1991 -> USSR dissolves; Gorbachev resigns

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Yugoslav breakdown

FEDERAL ORDER -> loses communist binding framework

LEADERS -> mobilise aggressive nationalism

MIXED POPULATIONS -> territorial claims overlap

HESITATION -> war and displacement deepen

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Bosnia to Kosovo

1991-95 -> Yugoslav wars and ethnic cleansing

1995 -> Dayton settles Bosnia

BOUNDARIES -> disputes remain

1999 -> Kosovo crisis and NATO intervention

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: European integration ladder

1951-52 -> ECSC pools strategic industry

1957 -> Treaty of Rome creates EEC

1973 -> first enlargement

1992-93 -> Maastricht creates deeper EU framework

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Deepening versus widening

DEEPENING -> political and monetary authority expands

WIDENING -> more states enter

2004 -> former communist states join

TENSION -> sovereignty and unequal economies persist

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: New-order claim

CAPABILITY -> USA appears sole superpower

LEGITIMACY -> consent remains incomplete

INSTITUTIONS -> UN authority still matters

VERDICT -> unipolar moment, contested order

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: War-on-terror sequence

11 SEPT 2001 -> transnational attack
AFGHANISTAN -> Taliban regime targeted
SECURITY -> dispersed networks become central
IRAQ 2003 -> intervention divides the order

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Iraq legitimacy test

POWER -> US-UK capacity to invade

AUTHORISATION -> no clear Security Council basis

RESULT -> institutional disagreement

LESSON -> capability cannot manufacture legitimacy

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Economic stagnation, nationality pressures, legitimacy loss, arms burdens, reform choices and international diplomacy interacted; neither Western pressure nor one leader alone supplies a sufficient cause.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Arab Spring divergence

DEC 2010 -> protests begin in Tunisia

COMMON GRIEVANCE -> uprisings spread

STATE/ARMY -> response capacity differs

EXTERNAL ROLE -> outcomes diverge sharply

EVIDENCE LIMIT: The post-1991 order combined a US-led unipolar moment with EU integration, globalisation, regional wars and continuing Russian, Chinese and Global South agency, so neither final-peace nor Western-teleology claims are safe.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: New world order answer spine

COLLAPSE -> stagnation, reform, mobilisation and restraint

EUROPE -> Yugoslav fragmentation plus EU enlargement

ORDER -> US predominance tested by terror and Iraq

VERDICT -> no linear democratic or unipolar settlement